



TOWN of BROOKLINE
Massachusetts
Park and Recreation Commission

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John Bain, Chairperson

Nancy O'Connor, Vice Chairperson

Clara Batchelor

James Carroll

Daniel Lyons

Nancy Madden

Antonia Bellalta

Director of Parks and Open Space

Erin Chute Gallentine

Director of Recreation

Lisa Paradis

Park and Recreation Commission Meeting

June 14, 2010

6:30 p.m.

Town Hall

333 Washington Street

Brookline, MA 02445

MINUTES

Present: Chairperson John Bain, Vice-Chairperson Nancy O'Connor, Commissioner Clara Batchelor, Commissioner Daniel Lyons, Commissioner Nancy Madden

Also present: Erin Gallentine, Director of Parks and Open Space, Lisa Paradis, Director of Recreation

Attendees: See Attached

Meeting was called to order at 6:30 p.m. by John Bain.

Public Comment:

- R. Sneider, TMM 6 and Billy Ward abutter, appeared to discuss Billy Ward Playground with the Commission and staff. She expressed concern that it was not on the CIP for this year, and that it was pushed out due to lack of available funding. E. Gallentine informed her that Billy Ward is scheduled for design in 2013 and construction in 2014. The Directors and the Commission all agreed that the renovation of Billy Ward Playground was a priority. R. Sneider has also researched the property and found no legal restrictions on the property besides Article 97. R. Sneider would like the park to have more open space and less play space, which she thinks will serve the demographic better and be more consistent with other parks. They briefly discussed the issue of restrictions and play equipment.
- Later in the meeting J. Menke, resident, appeared to request a free pool pass for a day, which he was promised at an earlier meeting but had not received. L. Paradis gave him the pass.

Approval of Minutes

On motion, it was unanimously voted:

N. O'Connor moved to approve the minutes from 5/10. C. Batchelor seconded. All in favor.

Flag Day – Lisa Paradis

Flag Day will be 6/20. L. Paradis asked for volunteers to ride the department float in the parade. Several Commissioners plan to attend and will ride the float.

Parks and Open Space Update – Erin Gallentine

- The Juniper Street Playground Re-Opening Celebration was a success and a press release has been sent to the Tab. This is also the first playground with the new EVOS climbing net play equipment.
- The Dane Park Re-Opening Celebration was also a success with lots of positive feedback.
- The overall lowest bid for the Winthrop Park renovation was Sunshine Paving Company. E. Gallentine discussed various issues with approval of the subcontractors, and the Commission discussed how to potentially avoid such issues in the future. E. Gallentine expects to award and execute the contract by the end of the month. N. O'Connor asked about project oversight. One of the Town engineers will be the oversight manager. J. Bain asked about protecting the rose garden. It will be fenced, but the Friends group and Town staff will have access for maintenance.
- E. Gallentine and Commissioners discussed the ideal frequency for park and playground renovations, the importance of maintaining/renovating the parks regularly, parks that are currently in need of renovation, and how to address budget issues related to the renovations.
- E. Gallentine and Commissioners discussed the issue of Building Department and other vehicles parking at Larz.
- There was a major storm event on 6/6 that caused significant damage to Town trees. Crews are doing removal and safety pruning, and the Department of Public Works will ask for a reserve fund transfer from the Board of Selectmen to cover the costs.
- The structural assessment is complete for the Temple of Love at Larz. Full replacement will be very expensive and restoration is not possible, though some patching is happening. E. Gallentine asked the Commission to consider how to prioritize this over the long term.
- The Town is working on draft language for combined conservation and preservation restrictions for Fisher Hill Reservoir, which the state Department of Capital Asset Management is requiring to be filed with the deed. The Board of Selectmen will approve it, but DCAM is requiring that a third party hold the restrictions for independent oversight.
- Brookline Travel Soccer is actively raising money to install synthetic turf at lower Soule. This would require Conservation Commission and Park and Recreation Commission approval. The Commission discussed the benefits and impacts of synthetic turf at this location. L. Paradis will talk further with A. Einhorn, President of Brookline Travel Soccer.
- L. Paradis and E. Gallentine have met with one of the daycare permitters regarding daycare usage of parks and playgrounds. The daycares are working on a schedule of when they will use the spaces to avoid conflicts, and the Commission will wait to assess how this works.
- The Pender Rotary dedication will be 7/11.

Recreation Update: Lisa Paradis

- The golf course bunker work is complete, including removal of a small bridge and drainage improvements, which have gotten good feedback and are handling rainfall events well. There will be a larger project extension with creek renovations next, possibly this winter.
- Soule Early Childhood Center is completing their school year and having end of the year festivities. Their summer programs are full at this point.
- The pool was shut down for a two-week period for annual maintenance at the facility.
- The Amory clay tennis courts opened over Memorial Day weekend. The courts will be laser graded later in the season.
- The Friends of Brookline Recreation are planning a big gala event for next fall. Commissioners will receive information by mail about the event.
- The proposal to film scenes for a major motion picture at Larz is not moving forward since both sides were not able to agree on cost. L. Paradis and Commissioners discussed how the process helped to think about similar proposals in the future and protective measures for the park or educational components that could be included.
- Commissioners also received a list of Recreation updates and information from Melissa Battite, Recreation Supervisor.

Golf Green Fees Increase – Brian Bain and Jack Neville

L. Paradis discussed the fiscal constraints that are challenging the golf course, and B. Bain discussed impacts of OPEB related fees to the enterprise fund. B. Bain and J. Neville presented a proposed fee schedule, which would increase all fees by \$1 on July 1, 2010. They discussed that these rates are still lower than competitors, and explained how they compare to other public courses. Commissioners discussed the proposed fees and the timing and amount of increases.

On motion, it was unanimously voted:

C. Batchelor moved to accept the fee increases at the Robert T. Lynch Municipal Golf Course at Putterham Meadows as proposed. N. Madden seconded. All in favor.

Discussion of Field Policy

Commissioners and staff continued a discussion about forming a comprehensive formal field policy, with a special event policy incorporated or as an addendum. L. Paradis presented a spreadsheet of proposed field fees for different user groups, which she and E. Gallentine had prepared, as well as a spreadsheet of user group statistics. Commissioners also received a draft athletic field use and allocation policy prepared by L. Paradis and E. Gallentine. Commissioners discussed the proposed policy including how to address field versus special event permits, how to organize the document, and what information to include. They also discussed the proposed fees in detail including the actual fees, how to handle the fees administratively, how the fee money would be used, how and when to approach user groups and the implications of fees for the different groups, how residency factors into the proposed fees, and how user fees are handled in other towns. The group discussed the timeframe for implementing new fees and policies. They agreed to continue their discussion at the next meeting, but to separate the discussion of the user group fees and the policy to focus the discussion.

New Business

There was no new business to discuss.

N. Madden moved to adjourn. C. Batchelor seconded. All in favor.